Free Therapy Campaign

(10 September – 10 October 2025)

01. Executive Summary

From September 10 to October 10, 2025, Sorry I'm Not Sorry: We Are All Sick implemented a Free Therapy Campaign as part of Suicide Prevention Month. The campaign sought to reduce suicide risk and promote mental well-being by offering free therapy and counselling sessions to individuals across Malawi and abroad.

A total of 9 psychosocial counsellors volunteered to provide at least two therapy sessions for each client, reaching 160 individuals from 23 locations. The campaign focused on connecting people in distress with safe, confidential, and professional psychosocial support while encouraging help-seeking behaviour and reducing stigma around mental health.

This initiative marked a practical step toward bridging the mental health care gap in Malawi and provided valuable insights to inform the 2025 National Suicide Prevention Campaign.

02. Background & Rationale

Malawi continues to face a rising suicide rate, particularly among men, largely due to stigma, cultural silence, and limited access to mental health services. To respond to this crisis, Sorry I'm Not Sorry launched a month-long Free Therapy Campaign to coincide with global Suicide Prevention Month (10 September – 10 October).

The campaign aligned with the organization's broader mission to demystify mental health, normalize therapy, and prevent suicide through community-driven psychosocial support.

03. Campaign Goal

To reduce suicide risk and promote mental well-being by providing free, confidential therapy and counselling services while raising awareness during Suicide Prevention Month.

04. Specific Objectives

1. Provide at least two free therapy sessions per client.
2. Promote help-seeking behaviour as a positive, life-saving action.
3. Establish a referral and follow-up system for high-risk individuals.
4. Strengthen collaboration between government and civil society in mental health promotion.

Theme: "Healing in Action: Restoring Hope Through Free Therapy"
Compiled by: Joseph Daniel Sukali, Founder & Country Director

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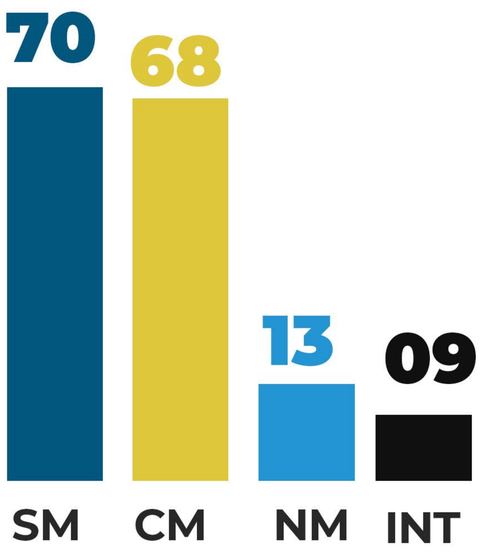
05 Implementation Overview

Duration	10 September – 10 October 2025
Counsellors Engaged	9 (trained psychosocial counsellors)
Delivery Method	Hybrid (in-person and online)
Target Group	Individuals facing psychological distress or suicidal ideation
Coordination	Sorry I'm Not Sorry: We Are All Sick

6. Geographic Coverage

Southern Malawi	Blantyre (45), Zomba (9), Mangochi (7) Mulanje (4), Chiradzulu (2), Nsanje (1), Thyolo (1), Balaka (1)
Central Malawi	Lilongwe (59), Kasungu (4), Ntcheu (2), Ntchisi (2), Mchinji (1)
Northern Malawi	Mzuzu (9), Mzimba (3), Karonga (1)
International	South Africa (2), Mozambique (1), Zambia (1), Germany (1), USA (2), Lesotho (1), Spain (1)



Total Number Of Clients :

160

Theme: "Healing in Action: Restoring Hope Through Free Therapy"
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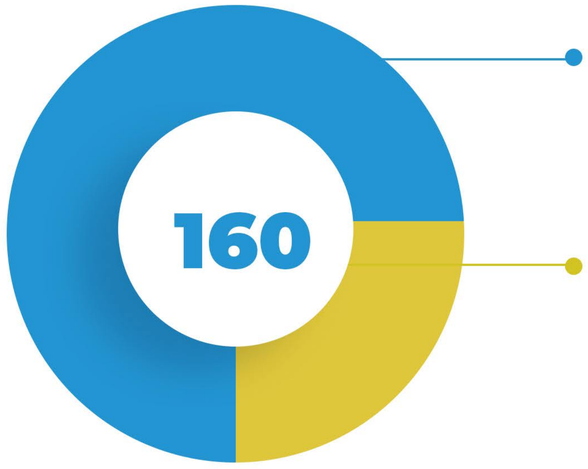
7. Demographic Breakdown

7.1 Gender Distribution

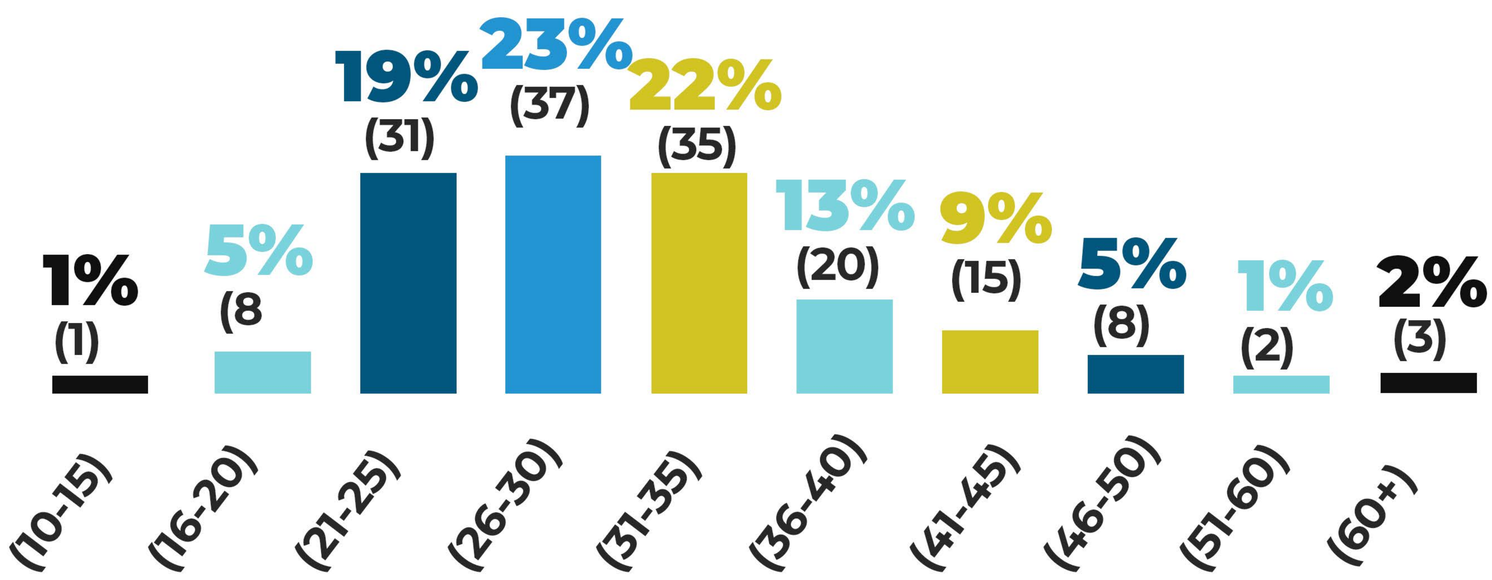


♀ **73%**
Females (117)

♂ **27%**
Males (43)

Observation:
Women were nearly three times more likely to seek help than men. The disparity underlines the persistent stigma surrounding men's emotional expression, a critical area for targeted intervention in future campaigns.

7.2 Age Distribution



Insight:
The **21–35 age** group **(64%)** represented the largest proportion of clients, reflecting the growing psychological strain among young adults and those in early careers.

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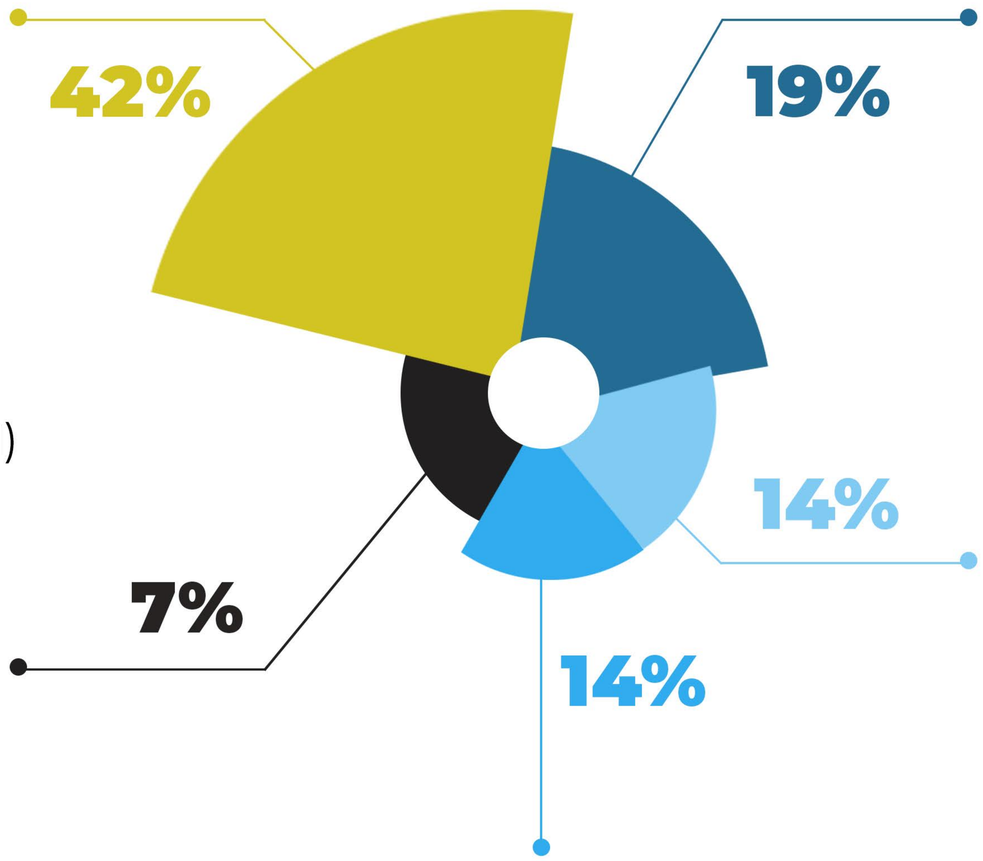
08. Key Issues

A. Relationship & Family Issues (43%)

- Marital Constraints (28)
- Relationship Constraints (Non matrimonial) (15)
- Divorce (12)
- Family conflicts (8)
- Rejection / Abandonment (3)
- Abusive parent (1)
- Disconnection from children (1)



B. Psychological & Emotional Health (19%)

- Addiction (10)
- Emotional abuse (7)
- PTSD (3)
- Childhood trauma (3)
- Identity crisis (5)
- Low self-esteem (1)
- Post-partum depression (2)

C. Grief & Loss (14%)

- Death of spouse (5)
- Death of parent (6)
- Loss of a child (2)
- Miscarriage(s) (8)
- Abortion (grief) (2)

D. Socioeconomic & Work-Related Stress (14%)

- Unemployment(7)
- Job loss (5)
- Work-related issues (3)
- Debt (2)
- Parental expectations (2)
- Stagnation (1)
- Academic pressure (2)

E. Health-Related Challenges (7%)

- Chronic illness (5)
- HIV sero-status (2)
- Pregnancy (emotional/unplanned) (4)

Note:
Some clients presented multiple overlapping issues.

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09. Key Outcomes

- **160 individuals** accessed free psychosocial support services.
- **9 counsellors** actively provided therapy sessions,demonstrating professional commitment.
- **Increased awareness** of therapy as a practical, life-saving intervention.
- Strengthened data and understanding of common psychosocial challenges in Malawi.
- Elevated Sorry I'm Not Sorry as a credible advocacy platform for mental health.

11. Lessons Learned

- The community-based volunteer model is effective but needs institutional backing.
- Therapy uptake increases when awareness and confidentiality are emphasized.
- Continuous capacity building is necessary for ethical, trauma-informed care.
- Collaboration with health facilities and churches improves referral and follow-up.

10. Challenges

- Low male participation due to stigma and gender norms.
- High demand versus limited counsellor capacity.
- Inconsistent data capture from some decentralized counsellors.
- Limited digital connectivity for online sessions in rural areas.

12. Recommendations

- Scale up the campaign into a national annual initiative (2026 onwards).
- Develop a male-focused mental health sub-program.
- Provide ongoing clinical supervision and refresher training for counsellors.
- Strengthen data management systems for future campaigns.
- Enhance partnerships with government, CSOs, and private practitioners.

13. Conclusion

The 2025 Free Therapy Campaign demonstrated that community-led mental health action can restore hope and save lives. Through compassion, professionalism, and collaboration, Sorry I'm Not Sorry: We Are All Sick connected 160 individuals to healing and safety.

This pilot effort provides a foundation for the 2026 "Free Therapy" National Suicide Prevention Campaign, which will expand partnerships, coverage, and sustainability. The organization reaffirms its vision of building a mentally resilient Malawi, where seeking help is seen as strength, not shame.

Prepared by: Joseph Daniel Sukali | Founder & Country Director
Sorry I'm Not Sorry: We Are All Sick | Date: October 2025